DIVINE OTUMERE WELDONE

By Pipeline, Agbura Town, Yenagoa, Bayelsa State.
Phone: +2349065667431 **Email:** weldonedivineo@gmail.com

Professional Summary

Governance and policy professional with over seven years of research experience in development, democracy, peace, and security across Nigeria and West Africa. Demonstrated ability to generate research ideas, design research frameworks, and produce high-quality policy briefs and research reports to inform advocacy and policy interventions. Strong competencies in monitoring and evaluation, programme coordination, and multi-stakeholder engagement across civil society and policy environments. Experienced in programme support, policy engagement, and producing research outputs. Author of multiple, peer reviewed, publications on governance, corruption, and regional security in West Africa. Technologically proficient, with advanced knowledge of Microsoft Office and Google Workspace for research and documentation.

Relevant Experience

Research Officer| Initiative for Research, Innovation and Advocacy in Development, Abuja, Nigeria. | Jan. 2024 – June 2024

- Produced policy briefs, analytical reports and press statements to support advocacy.
- Led and coordinated research projects on electoral governance, gender and social inclusion, and democracy in Nigeria.
- Supported grant deliverables by drafting proposals and concept notes, and reviewing reports.
- Engaged with stakeholders including civil society actors, academics, and policy practitioners to support research initiatives.
- Supervised and mentored research interns to ensure productivity and adherence to research standards.
- Contributed to knowledge management through editing, proofreading, and strengthening policy outputs.

Research Associate | Initiative for Research, Innovation and Advocacy in Development | May 2023 - Dec. 2023

- Managed research interns to ensure productivity.
- Drafted research reports and press statements.
- Proofread and strengthened written briefs, reports and public statements.

Programme and Research Associate | Peace to the Streets and Creeks Movement, Yenagoa, Bayelsa State. | 2022

- Coordinated youth focused peacebuilding and sensitisation activities across multiple communities in Bayelsa State.
- Contributed to community outreach campaigns addressing cultism, youth violence, and electoral related tensions.
- Supported development of communication materials and advocacy content promoting peace education and civic engagement.
- Collaborated with local stakeholders to expand the reach of peace campaigns.
- Documented project activities and contributed to reports highlighting community peacebuilding outcomes.

Freelance Research and Policy Consultant| 2016 - Date

- Collection and analysis of data for individuals and NGOs.
- Conducted field research, data analysis, and policy writing for governance and development projects.
- Preparation of policy briefs.
- Field visits and data gathering.
- Rapporteuring for state-led events.

Education

- **MSc. (In View)** | Niger Delta University, Wilberforce Island, Bayelsa State.
- **Bachelor of Science in Political Science**| Niger Delta University, Wilberforce Island, Bayelsa State | 2015

Publications

- **Weldone, O. D.** (2026). How can reconciliation improve buy-in for Operation Safe Corridor? *Centre for Democracy and Development (CDD-West Africa).* https://www.cddwestafrica.org/blog/how-can-reconciliation-improve-buy-in-for-operation-safe-corridor/
- Cocodia, J., & **Weldone, O. D.** (2026, forthcoming). *The necessity for restructuring in Nigeria: Balancing structure, identity and security*. Nigerian Political Science Association.
- **Weldone, O. D.** (2025). Why a state of emergency in Rivers State is a bad idea. *Centre for Democracy and Development (CDD-West Africa).* https://www.cddwestafrica.org/blog/why-a-state-of-emergency-in-rivers-state-is-a-bad-idea/
- **Weldone, O. D.**, & Prince, F. D. (2025). Institutional weaknesses and corruption in Nigeria: Implications for democratisation amidst West Africa's coup wave. *Journal of Political Science and Leadership Research, 11*(10), 172–184.
- Tokpo, C. E., & **Weldone, O. D.** (2025). Resurgence of military rule in West Africa and the formation of the Alliance of Sahel States: Implications for regional stability. *Journal of Political Science and Leadership Research, 11*(8), 78–93.
- Ogroh, S. E., **Weldone, O. D.**, & Abari, J. E. (2024). Ethno-territorial conflict and national integration: The case of herders and farmers in Nigeria. *International Journal of Strategic Research in Public Administration and Organizational Process, 4*(1), 1–15.
- Ogroh, E. S., **Weldone, O. D.**, & Abari, E. J. (2021). Nigeria: The challenges of herders-farmers' conflict and national integration. In S. I. Ibaba, K. J. Cocodia, & A. F. Sanubi (Eds.), *Tragedy of a nation: Insight into the dynamics of conflict and insecurity in Nigeria.* Zelon Integrated Services Ltd.

Skills

- Programme coordination and implementation
- Microsoft Office Excel
- Microsoft Office Word
- Google Workspace
- Graphic Design
- Stakeholder engagement
- Collaboration and leadership
- Critical thinking and problem solving
- Time Management
- Research project management
- Survey design and data gathering
- Academic/policy/technical writing
- Data entry and analysis

Hobbies

- Reading of novels, travelling, and playing Scrabble.

Referees

- **Professor Jude Cocodia**
  Lecturer Department of Political Science, Niger Delta University, Wilberforce Island, Bayelsa State.
  Email: jcocodia41@gmail.com
- **Angalapu Dengiyefa**
  Research Analyst, Centre for Democracy and Development, West Africa.
  Email: greatdengis@gmail.com
- **Professor Iyabrade Ikporukpo**
  Lecturer, Department of Political Science, Niger Delta University, Wilberforce Island, Bayelsa State.
  Email: ijikporukpo@gmail.com